

FOR TEXTS AND EMAILS, NOT JUST CALLS

The BIFF Text Template

BIFF is a widely-used conflict-communication method: keep written messages to a hostile or hurt co-parent **Brief, Informative, Friendly, and Firm**. It's not about being cold. It's about not giving a bad moment more fuel than it needs.

BRIEF

2-5 sentences. No history lesson, no rebuttal to every line of their message.

INFORMATIVE

Just the facts they need: the time, the plan, the ask.

FRIENDLY

One neutral or warm opening line, even if you don't feel it yet.

FIRM

End the message. No invitation to keep arguing.

TEMPLATE: REQUESTING A SCHEDULE CHANGE

"Hi [name], hope the week's going okay. I need to ask for a change: [specific request, specific date]. Let me know if that works or if [specific alternative] is better for you. Thanks for working with me on this."

TEMPLATE: DECLINING A REQUEST

"Thanks for asking. That won't work for me this time: [one brief reason, optional]. I can do [alternative] if that helps."

TEMPLATE: ADDRESSING A MISSED PICKUP

"Pickup was missed today at [time]. [Child] was fine, just wanted you aware. Let's confirm the plan for next time by [day]."